



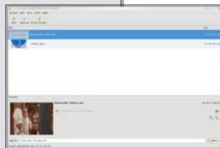
Brasero 2.26.1

Brasero started as a voluntary GNOME project, and has recently become an integral part of it. It is now the official disc burning software in GNOME, though the Nautilus burner is still shipped along side Brasero.

In short, Brasero is all about simplicity. You just couldn't go wrong here. Brasero offers the easiest to use interface you can ever come across with any sort of burning software. It might not be as feature rich as Nero and K3b, but it's apt for lay persons looking to get their work done.

Brasero doesn't sport Blu-Ray or HD-DVD support. It didn't even burn single files above 4GB. However, unlike K3b, Brasero notifies the user that it cannot burn files over 4GB in advance. Some basic features that Brasero boasts of are:

- Data CD/DVD
- Audio CD
- CD/DVD Copy
- Erase CD/DVD
- Save/load projects
- Burn CD/DVD images and cue files
- Song, image and video previewer
- Device detection thanks to HAL



- File change notification (requires kernel > 2.6.13)
 - A customisable GUI (when used with GDL)
 - Supports Drag and Drop/Cut and Paste from Nautilus (and others apps)
 - Can use files on a network as long as the protocol is handled by GNOME-vfs
 - Can search for files thanks to Beagle (search is based on keywords or on file type)
 - Can display a playlist and its contents (note that playlists are automatically searched through Beagle)
 - All disc IO is done asynchronously to prevent the application from blocking
- Brasero is quite simple to use and suits everyone, but the lack of features—especially the inability to burn a single file of size over 4GB—

cannot be overlooked. Added to that, there is no support for Blu-Ray at present. Adding media files in bulk is not possible, so you need to search and browse repeatedly to add files. A bulk dropper is a must! Also, it takes a lot of time scanning for media files.

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Pros:

Easy to use, decent burning speed, good for low-end usage.

Cons:

No support for Blue-ray and HD-DVD, less features, doesn't support advanced ripping & burning options like the other two.

Platform: All distro supported

Price: Free (as in beer)

Website: www.gnome.org/projects/brasero

After burn marks

Contrary to what people think, the disc burning scenario is pretty despairing in Linux—the only software I can vouch for right now seems to be Nero. Apart from the lack of ripping features, it has everything a reliable software must provide. The inability of K3b and Brasero to burn larger file sizes cannot be ignored, and something must be done to fill the gaps so that they can compete with paid alternatives. K3b still has some great and usable tools, and is certainly more feature-rich than Brasero.

It is sad that major players like Roxio and Cyberlink haven't introduced their offering to the Linux market yet, and until then, I guess it's Nero Linux for me. If you

have the licensed OEM disc, then go for it. For anything else, K3b has the upper hand. 

Resources

- Nero Linux: <http://www.nero.com/ena/linux3-features.html>
- K3b: <http://k3b.plainblack.com/k3b-news>
- Brasero: <http://projects.gnome.org/brasero/>
- Linux burners UDF incompatibility: <http://support.microsoft.com/kb/899527/>

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